GMS WEEKLY
Your Source for Recycling News

July 31st, 2026
Week 31
Volume 282, Issue 1246

Highlights:

- **Ceasefire collapses.**
- **Crude retreats.**
- **Passage reopens.**
- **Beachings resume.**

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QUOTE of the WEEK

"Everything comes to him who hustles while he waits."
- Thomas Edison

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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PAUSE BREAKS, PASSAGE OPENS

The week opened with a ceasefire and closed without one, which by now qualifies as continuity. On Monday, President Trump said the United States had halted strikes at Iran's request while warning that attacks would resume without a new deal. By Wednesday, Tehran had struck American assets across the region and Washington had answered with strikes on dozens of Iranian military targets. By Thursday, the two were trading missile barrages, while Saudi Arabia joined in striking Iranian-backed proxies directly. The pause was announced on Monday and buried by Wednesday. Even the ceasefires are now on a weekly publication schedule.

Oil, remarkably, spent the same week deflating. Brent fell from last Friday's USD 97.63 to near USD 87, with WTI at USD 83.78, leaving crude down roughly 11% on the week despite a 6.6% single-session surge during Wednesday's escalation. Prices remain more than 20% higher on the month. The reason sailed through the strait. 14 commodity vessels transited Hormuz on Wednesday, compared with single digits a week earlier, while Qatar pushed its first LNG cargo through and Saudi Arabia convened representatives from 43 countries to discuss protection of the sea lanes. Traffic through Hormuz has become the market's preferred peace correspondent. 14 ships said more on Wednesday than either government has all month. Further tanker attacks interrupted Black Sea loadings, while the Bab al-Mandab threat remains unresolved.

Freight spent the week changing its mind. The Baltic Dry Index slipped to a 4-week low of 2,632 on Wednesday before recovering 1.6% to 2,673 on Thursday. The Capesize index rebounded 2.5% to 4,167, while Panamaxes reached 2,040. The Supramax index, congratulated in this space last week for reaching 4-year highs, handed part of them back, easing to a 3-week low of 1,610. Fame in dry bulk has the shelf life of a tide table. For recycling, the mix is quietly constructive. Mid-size earnings are churning, the strait is functioning again, and owners have an exit route that physically works. The inflation calendar remained quiet, although the Federal Reserve held rates with 3 dissents. June's readings across the basin therefore remain operative until next week. Currencies moved first. USD/INR strengthened sharply to near 95.65 as crude retreated, the Taka slipped to 123.50, the Lira set fresh records near 47.51, and the Pakistani Rupee, as is now tradition, closed within a PKR 0.25 weekly range near 278.25.

At the beaches, Bangladesh is finally moving from recovery to activity. A month that killed at least 57 people is loosening its grip, floodwaters have receded, and the July 29 to August 1 tide window opened with the queue built during the flooding beginning to move. Chattogram has seen its first meaningful beachings since the rains began.

The recycling market found its voice as well. The chemical tanker Stolt Kikyo was confirmed sold at USD 455 per LDT, ending a month without a reported basin sale. 2 Alang facilities were also proposed for inclusion on the EU List, potentially opening the first direct channel for EU-flagged recycling candidates into India if approved. Bangladeshi sentiment firmed as local steel recovered, though the improvement has not yet fully reached vessel pricing, while Pakistan's plate held the sub-continent's top position near PKR 200,000 per ton.

The strait is letting ships through faster than the diplomats are letting words through. For the first time in a month, the beach, the tide and the passage are open at the same time. The market is not moving freely yet, but it is moving again.

GMS market rankings / pricing for week 31 of 2026 are on Page 5.

BANGLADESH

WINDOW OPENS, QUEUE MOVES

The window.

The July 29 to August 1 tide window opened on Wednesday and brought the first meaningful beaching activity at Chattogram since the rains began. The queue that built at anchorage through the flooding, including general cargo and container tonnage that arrived between July 18 and 23, moved onto the plots over Wednesday and Thursday, clearing most of the backlog over 2 tide cycles. Floodwaters across the affected districts have receded, relief operations have consolidated, and municipal crews report that waterlogging is easing sharply from the peak. A month that killed at least 57 people, most of them in Cox's Bazar, is finally loosening its grip. Recovery has moved from an operative word to observable activity. The next window with meaningful capacity runs from August 12 to 15.

Sentiment firms.

The market followed the weather. Buying interest remained firm through the week, with cash buyer enquiry described as healthy and end buyers returning after the first signs of easing. Local steel trading, which slowed sharply during the deluge, recovered as yards reopened and restocked. Local plate prices held near BDT 64,700 through Friday. The improvement in steel has not yet translated into stronger vessel pricing, which keeps this week's indications where they were last week. The gap between what mills will pay for plate and what recyclers will pay for ships remains the market's most closely watched spread.

Selectivity stays.

The caution that hardened after this month's sanctioned-tanker episode has not softened with the weather. Appetite continues to favour bulkers and units free of compliance exposure, while tanker histories still carry a discount due to paperwork and sanctions risk. USD/BDT slipped to 123.50, its weakest level since the February 2025 record of 123.87, gently testing the upper end of the range it has held through the summer. With no inflation print due until around August 6, June's 9.16% remains the operative reading for a few more days. The plot floor has dried. The queue is moving. The paperwork remains the only thing still capable of stopping a ship.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

MUTED MARKET, OPEN DOOR

Rupee relents.

USD/INR strengthened to near 95.65 by Friday, giving the Rupee its best week since spring as crude's retreat from triple digits eased the pressure that had pushed the pair within touching distance of May's record just a week ago. The Reserve Bank, visible on the offer for much of the month, spent this week largely unneeded. With no CPI print due until August 12, June's 4.38% surprise remains the operative number, though it is now being measured against a barrel more than 11% cheaper than last Friday.

Plates cross USD 400.

Local steel plate at Alang climbed from INR 38,500 to INR 39,000 during the week before returning to INR 38,500 by Friday. Currency movements nevertheless lifted the Friday USD equivalent above USD 400 to approximately USD 404 per ton. The move was driven more by currency than demand. Monsoon-curtailed cutting has kept plate supply tight, while downstream steel demand remains subdued and buying interest at the waterfront muted. Even so, the July 27 to August 4 tide window remains open, and the week's first reported sale in over a month suggests activity is beginning to return.

The door opens.

The week's structural development outweighed the trading. Two Alang recycling facilities were proposed for inclusion on the EU List, potentially creating the first direct pathway for EU-flagged vessels to be recycled in India once approved. Alongside India's position as the basin's only destination accepting dark-fleet histories, and with more than 115 valid Statements of Compliance, the country's competitive advantage continues to widen. The compliance moat is now being reinforced from both sides, sanctioned tonnage on one, Brussels-recognised facilities on the other. The deepest capacity, the strongest compliance profile, the weakest pricing and, perhaps, a door opening wider than before.

MARKET SALE REPORTED

VESSEL NAME	TYPE	LDT	REPORTED PRICE
Stolt Kikyo	Chemical Tanker	3,305	USD 455 / LDT (delivered Alang)

PAKISTAN

TOP OF THE BOARD, EMPTY BEACH

Priced to lead.

Gadani's plate quote held at PKR 200,000 per ton, near USD 714, consolidating last Friday's jump and keeping Pakistan at the top of the sub-continent's price board. Scrap posted the basin's strongest weekly gain, the shortage continues to support demand, and buying appetite remains firm. The fiscal case also holds, with lower property withholding tax and subsidised housing expected to support construction once the monsoon clears. This week's retreat in oil removed the one external pressure Islamabad least wanted on its import bill.

Rupee, as ever.

USD/PKR closed near 278.25, once again inside a range of barely 0.25 Rupees through a collapsed pause, renewed missile exchanges, and an 11% move in crude. The State Bank's 11.5% policy rate and disciplined reserve management continue to take the credit, while the description settled on in these pages still applies: less an exchange rate than a personality. Pakistan's July CPI lands on August 1, the basin's first fresh inflation print in a month, with June's 11.1% and its rare monthly decline still the benchmark to beat.

Queue, empty.

The waterfront tells the other half of the story. No new vessels were reported at Gadani for a 2nd consecutive week. Pakistan holds the region's best price and, for a fortnight running, has had nothing to spend it on, the market equivalent of winning an auction nobody attended. The reopening of Hormuz cuts both ways. Passage restores the flow of Gulf-positioned candidates, but it also restores those vessels to whichever market pays most, and Bangladesh's numbers remain out of reach. Gadani's edge remains speed and certainty, with no tide constraint and hungry yards. It now waits for the first owner who values a berth over the final basis point.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

STILL HELD, NOW WAITING

USD/TRY reached fresh record territory near 47.51, the managed slide continuing at its familiar pace, with the central bank still supplying the market to keep depreciation orderly and the effective overnight rate near 40% carrying the policy load. Last week's fourth consecutive hold at 37% is already old news. The committee has delivered its message. The next word belongs to the data.

Records, quietly.

That word arrives on Monday as July CPI is released, refreshing both of Turkey's inflation realities at once: the official June reading of 32.11%, the lowest since March, and the Inflation Research Group's parallel estimate of 51.4%. The month being measured saw crude briefly touch USD 100 before retreating to USD 87, making this one of the more difficult inflation prints to handicap. Whatever the outcome, few expect the gap between the two measures to narrow.

Monday's number.

Aliaga's plate indications remained at USD 262 to USD 284 per LDT across vessel types, with a modest improvement in local steel once again falling short of lifting vessel pricing or activity. Turkey's share of the recycling market continues to rest on EU regulation, Basel Convention compliance and specialist tonnage rather than price. The week's most important structural development therefore occurred well beyond its shores, as 2 Alang recycling facilities were proposed for inclusion on the EU List. Turkey's niche remains secure for now, but the competitive landscape is beginning to change.

Niche, unchanged.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 31 of 2026, GMS Market Rankings / Vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	**Steady**	445-450 / LDT	465-470 / LDT	475-480 / LDT
2	Pakistan	**Steady**	443-448 / LDT	463-468 / LDT	473-478 / LDT
3	India	**Steady**	422-427 / LDT	442-447 / LDT	452-457 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Steady**	262-264 / LDT	272-274 / LDT	282-284 / LDT

DID YOU KNOW?

- ***72.55 million MT of CO_2 emissions avoided*** *through ship recycling at Alang is equivalent to the emissions from burning approximately* ***27 billion litres of diesel fuel.***

- ***44.4 billion kWh of energy saved*** *through ship recycling at Alang equals approximately* ***12% of India's annual domestic electricity consumption.***

- ***124.5 million barrels of oil saved*** *through ship recycling at Alang equal approximately* ***19.8 billion litres****, enough to fill around* ***396 million standard 50-litre passenger vehicle fuel tanks.***

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
August 15 – Independence Day	July 27 – August 04

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
August 05 - July Uprising Day August 26 - Eid-e-Milad-un-Nabi	July 29 – August 01 August 12 – August 15

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
August 14 – Independence Day August 25 – Eid Milad-un-Nabi	August 30 – Victory Day

ALANG - Port Position as of July 31, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Basar	3,901	Fishing Vessel	*Delivered July 30*
2	Elan	24,603	Oil Tanker	*Delivered July 29*
3	Eva	3,152	Chemical Tanker	*Delivered July 28*
4	Pine Arrow	12,574	General Cargo	*Delivered July 28*
5	Endeavour	835	Fishing Vessel	Arrived July 26
6	Stolt Kikyo	3,305	Chemical Tanker	*Delivered July 25*

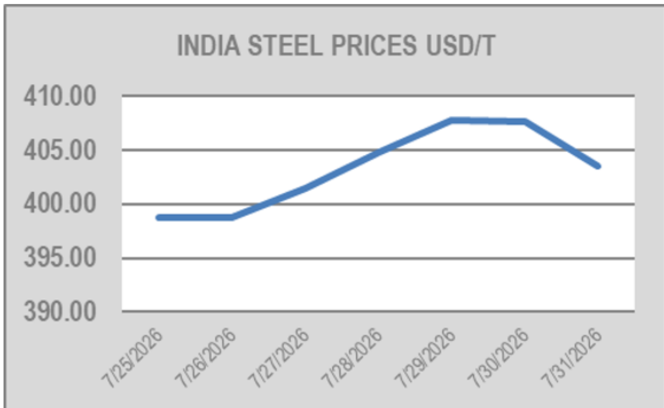
CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of July 31, 2026

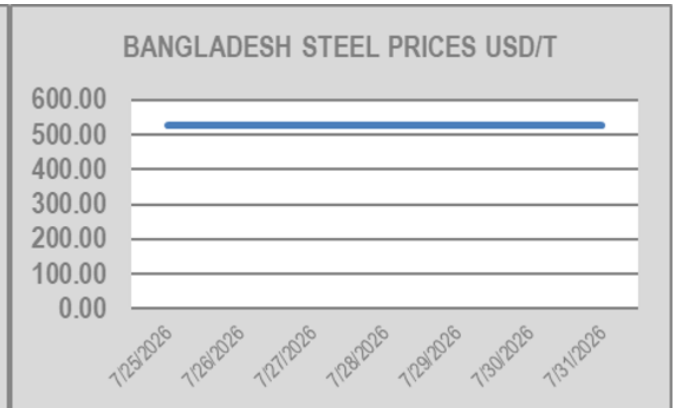
No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Gas II	2,214	LPG Tanker	Arrived July 29
2	Jin 30	3,666	Ro-Ro Steel Carrier	*Delivered July 29*
3	Sunny	2,217	Container	*Delivered July 29*
4	Wantong 497	3,610	General Cargo	*Delivered July 29*
5	Bagus	2,385	General Cargo	*Delivered July 26*
6	Ever Delight	1,557	General Cargo	*Delivered July 25*

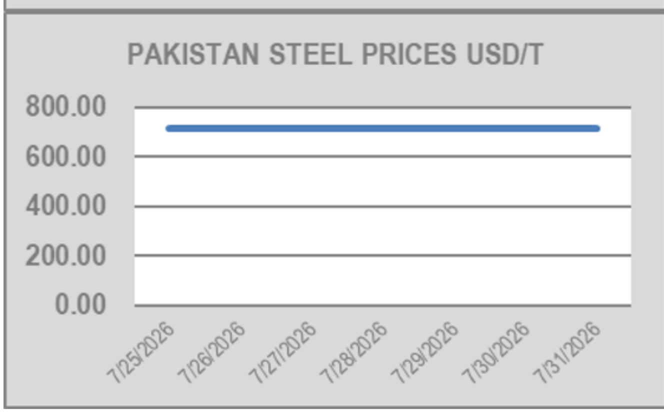
GADANI - Port Position as of July 31, 2026

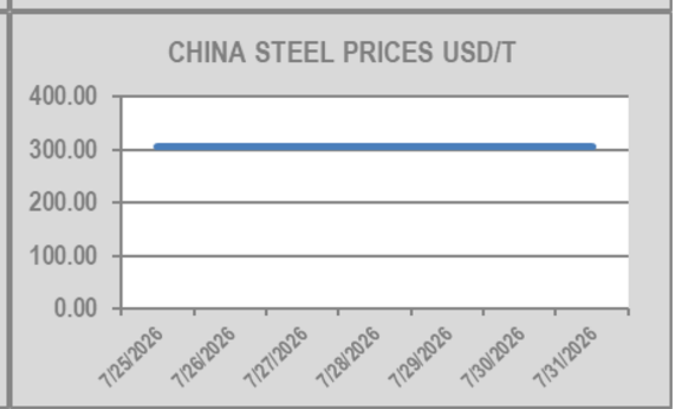
No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
No new vessels reported.				

DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
7/25/2026	398.72	38,500.00	714.29	200,000.00	527.95	64,700.00	306.32
7/26/2026	398.72	38,500.00	714.29	200,000.00	527.95	64,700.00	306.32
7/27/2026	401.42	38,500.00	714.29	200,000.00	527.95	64,700.00	306.32
7/28/2026	404.80	38,800.00	714.29	200,000.00	527.95	64,700.00	306.32
7/29/2026	407.74	39,000.00	714.29	200,000.00	527.95	64,700.00	306.32
7/30/2026	407.61	39,000.00	714.29	200,000.00	527.95	64,700.00	306.32
7/31/2026	403.56	38,500.00	714.29	200,000.00	527.95	64,700.00	306.32









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